and Customs of War on Land and the annexed *Hague Regulations* contained provisions on the treatment of prisoners.

3. *Laws of Neutrality:* The status of neutrality relates to the rights and duties of neutral states on the one hand and of belligerent states on the other. The duties under such circumstances of both the neutrals and the belligerents include:

(a) duties of abstentions from giving any sort of assistance direct or indirect to either belligerent sides by the neutrals and the prohibition of commitment of warlike acts on the neutrals by the belligerents.

(b) duties of prevention by the neutrals within their territory and warlike measures, enlistment of troops and the like, and also the belligerent's duty to prevent the ill-treatment of neutral envoys or neutral subjects and any injury to neutral property on enemy territory occupied by it.

(c) duties of acquiescence in the acts of the belligerent states by the neutral states with respect to the commerce of its nationals if they are duly warranted by laws of war-like seizure of vessels under its flag for carriage of contraband, adjudications by Prize Courts and the like. Similarly, belligerent states must also acquiesce in by neutral states of such members of its armed forces as taking refuge in neutral territory or in granting of temporary asylum by the neutral ports to hostile warships so that necessary repairs may be effected.

Is International Law a Proper Law?

Many consider international law as the vanishing point of jurisprudence. The characteristic feature of international system is the sovereignty and unaccountability of states, which makes the applicability of international law less effective. Hoffman[7] argues, "International law like its Siamese twin and enemy, war, remains a crystallization of all that keeps world politics *sui generic*". In times of political harmony, international law is applicable and, in times of dissonance, war takes over.

One theory has upheld that international law is not a true law but a code of moral force only. The forerunner of this school of thought